

be determined by your credit history and score; the better your score, the better the interest rates you will be offered.

Financing through a dealership works similarly to financing through a bank, except that the dealership is helping secure the financing for you. They will run a credit check on you, examine your finances, and send this information to lenders who will determine whether or not you get a loan and what the terms will be. Remember, the better your credit score and history, the better the rates you will be offered. The lender is often the financial department of the dealership, like Toyota Financial. While this option is more convenient than going to a bank, it may not offer you the best terms for the loan. You need to compare these choices and determine which option is best for you.

Only after you have decided which kind of car you want, know the price range, have found specific cars online you are interested in, and have considered financing options, should you begin speaking with a dealership. You need to have all of this information prepared and researched to show the salesperson you will be working with that you are a serious and knowledgeable customer who will not be taken advantage of.

Salespeople play a huge role in the car-buying process. People who sell cars are not bad people, but you need to understand their salary is based on commission: the more money you pay, the more money they make. Here are some common things you can expect from the people selling you a car:

- **They are crazy nice and personable.** They make you think, “Wow, this person really cares about me!” False. What a salesperson cares about is making a sale.
- **They will try to get you to commit as soon as possible by saying things like “This sale ends today,” or “This**